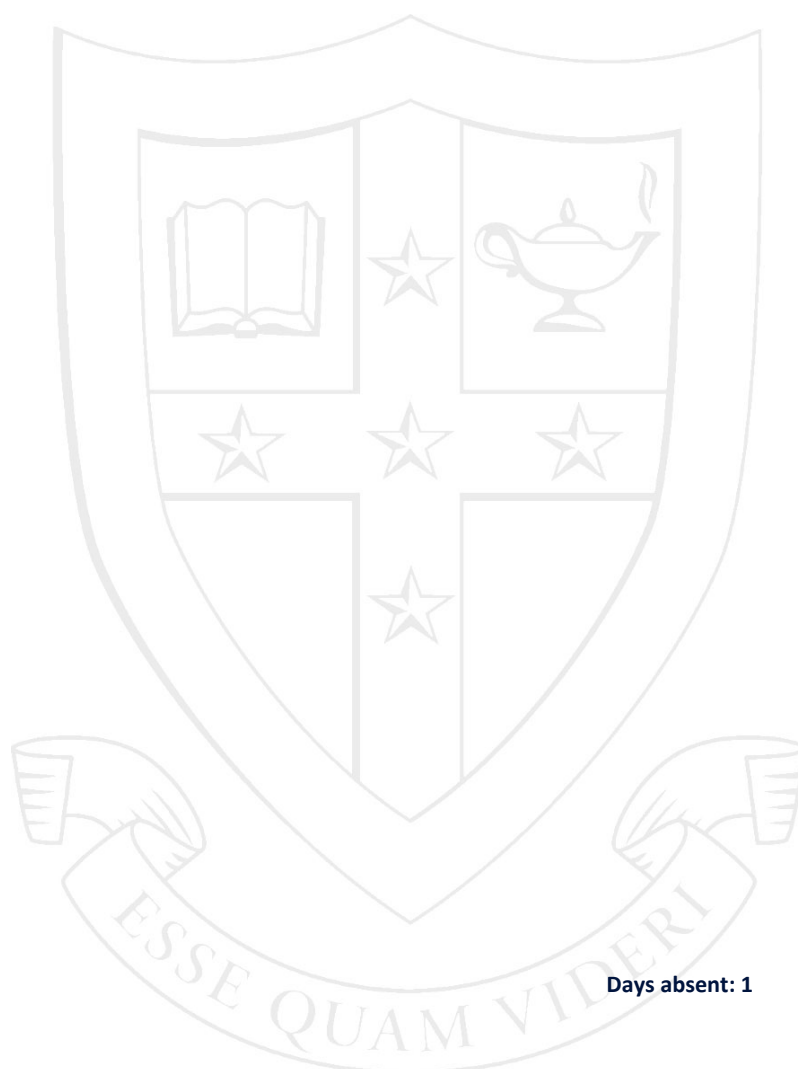


Report for Conner Beris

Term 3, 2021

Davidson House

Year 12



Davidson House



Days absent: 1

Conner's journey through Cranbrook from Kindergarten to Year 12 has been defined by his broad interests, connection with peers, quick wit, and an inclusive approach to leadership. These characteristics were especially evident this year when as House Captain he led with confidence, always injecting humour and good will into house assemblies and events. His intellect is unquestioned, he established this early in his senior years as the Dux of Year 7 and reprised this achievement in Year 9. Excelling in both the humanities and stem subjects he studied extension courses in English, History and Mathematics. The enigma of Conner is that, despite uniformly excellent outcomes in every academic subject, he is rarely spotted sitting still or studying silently with his head in a book. Rather, he is happiest in the middle of a football field in the epicentre of the action. His talent as a non-stop strategic director on the field and Basketball court naturally extend to house activities and inter-House events. He is an equally fierce competitor in debating as in bin-ball. Conner has been a proactive Prefect who enthusiastically involved himself in all aspects of school life, and constantly urged others to take up opportunities alongside him. His positivity, teamwork and casual confidence have energised the house this year. He has been equally committed in his co-curricular life in debating, public speaking, and every social service opportunity available.

Mentor: Mrs Fiona Crawford

Housemaster: Mr Simon Pardey

This is an outstanding report. Conner has met the challenges of Term 3 superbly and is well placed for a strong HSC result. I would also like to commend Conner on his outstanding contribution to the School during his time at Cranbrook. I wish him every success for the future.

Conner has also been a fine Prefect of the School and I am grateful for his leadership and service in this role.



Mr Robert Meakin
Head of Senior School

Academic summary

	Course	Performance grade	Rank in assessment tasks
English Advanced	2 Unit	A	Task 4: 2/94
English Extension 1	1 Unit	A	Task 3: 2/10
History Extension	1 Unit	A	Task 2: =2/17 Task 3: =5/17
Modern History	2 Unit	A	Task 3: =40/65 Task 4: =12/62
Physics	2 Unit	A	Task 4: =4/26

Explanatory Notes

Performance Grade: The following Performance Grade Scale indicates student performance in each secondary year at Cranbrook School.

It describes performance at each of five grade levels, based on classwork, homework and assessment tasks.

A The student has an extensive knowledge and understanding of the content and can readily apply this knowledge. In addition, the student has achieved a very high level of competence in the processes and skills and can apply these skills to new situations.

B The student has a thorough knowledge and understanding of the content and a high level of competence in the processes and skills. In addition, the student is able to apply this knowledge and these skills to most situations.

C The student has a sound knowledge and understanding of the main areas of content and has achieved an adequate level of competence in the processes and skills.

D The student has a basic knowledge and understanding of the content and has achieved a limited level of competence in the processes and skills.

E The student has an elementary knowledge and understanding in few areas of the content and has achieved very limited competence in some of the processes and skills.

English Advanced

2 Unit

Students completed their HSC Trials. As part of their revision for this task, students developed study techniques, consulted a range of sample responses and constructed responses to HSC style questions, including practice papers under timed conditions.

Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
analysing				✓
organising				✓
producing text				✓
using language				✓
Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class				✓
contributes positively in class				✓
completes set tasks				✓
acts on feedback to improve				✓

Performance grade: A Rank in assessment tasks: Task 4: 2/94

Conner the dual strengths of being able to formulate question responsive arguments and operate effectively under the pressure of examination conditions. These two qualities have served him well as evident in his strong performance in the HSC Trial examinations. His essays in particular have increasingly gained in their cogency. However, it is important that Conner does not become despondent in a post lockdown malaise; he has the potential to excel if he continues to address his relative weaknesses, in particular Module C and discussing the play 'The Crucible'. Planning responses to a range of challenging questions, working with peer study groups, and making refinements to his work will place him in a position to distinguish himself. I would like to encourage Conner to have a break so that when he returns, he can fully commit to the HSC.

Teacher: Mr Thomas McDonnell

English Extension 1

1 Unit

Students completed their HSC Trials. As part of their revision for this task, students developed study techniques, consulted a range of sample responses and constructed responses to HSC style questions, including practice papers under timed conditions.

Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
analysing				✓
organising			✓	
producing text				✓
using language				✓
Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class				✓
contributes positively in class				✓
completes set tasks				✓
acts on feedback to improve				✓

Performance grade: A Rank in assessment tasks: Task 3: 2/10

Conner's focus on the English Extension 1 rubric and its nuances has increased over the past term. Consequently, his performance has consolidated and harmonised with the strong examination strategies he possesses. His Literary Mindscape essay is significantly improved although a greater focus on form and how it interpolates with the conceptual dimensions of the texts, will further elevate the effectiveness of his compositions. Conner is an independent worker but I would like him to remain in touch so that we can target specific skills. A greater exposure to practice questions, examination practice, and work with his peers will place him in a strong position to succeed. It has been a pleasure teaching Conner, he has an agile mind and competitive spirit, which will serve him well if he works methodically.

Teacher: Mr Thomas McDonnell

History Extension

1 Unit

Students learn about the historical debates and changing interpretations of Cleopatra VII and study the 'Construction of History'. Students learn to locate, analyse and synthesise information from a range of sources and to communicate their findings using the appropriate text type.

Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
knowing and understanding				✓
investigating				✓
communicating				✓
thinking critically				✓
Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class				✓
contributes positively in class				✓
completes set tasks				✓
acts on feedback to improve				✓

Performance grade: A Rank in assessment tasks: Task 2: =2/17 Task 3: =5/17

I have enjoyed teaching Conner in History Extension. He should be proud of all the hard work he put into his History Project on whether the British Museum should return stolen objects which deservedly received high marks. Conner's contributions to class discussion and debate have demonstrated his engagement with the complex issues studied and critical thinking. In the trial examination, Conner demonstrated a thorough knowledge and understanding of both the Construction of History and Cleopatra, including sophisticated analysis. To aid his preparation for the HSC, Conner should practice as many past papers as possible and submit them for feedback. His focus should be on explicitly tying his knowledge and analysis to the question asked and including a greater degree of critical analysis of the unseen sources.

Teacher: Mr Michael Condie

Modern History

2 Unit

Students learn about events, personalities and issues that shaped the twentieth century, specifically Conflict in the Pacific and Change in the Modern World: Civil Rights in the USA 1945-1968. They explore historiographical issues associated with interpreting the past, learn to examine and analyse historical evidence and communicate their findings using appropriate text types.

Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
knowing and understanding				✓
investigating			✓	
communicating				✓
thinking critically				✓
Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class			✓	
contributes positively in class			✓	
completes set tasks				✓
acts on feedback to improve			✓	

Performance grade: A Rank in assessment tasks: Task 3: =40/65 Task 4: =12/62

After a period of mixed levels of engagement, Conner is again showing himself to be the committed and driven young man that I know he is. He is intelligent and has a natural flair for writing but he needs to remember that needs to be combined with consistent work for him to achieve to his high potential. Conner achieved solid results in the trial examination but for someone of his capabilities, there is still room for improvement. He scored highly in Power and Authority and the USSR and solid results for Civil Rights and Conflict in the Pacific. Making his writing more logical and including topic sentences in these sections will see him improve. To prepare for the HSC, Conner should complete practice responses and submit them for feedback. I have enjoyed teaching Conner and wish him every success for the future.

Teacher: Mr Michael Condie

Physics

2 Unit

Students learn about the formation of matter during the big bang. This leads to a consideration of nuclear physics and the atomic theory throughout the nineteenth century. Students finish with today's quantum mechanical model of the atom and the standard model of matter.

Achievement	Limited Development	Adequate Development	Substantial Development	Excellent Development
knowing and understanding				✓
inquiring and designing				✓
processing and evaluating				✓
reflecting on the impacts of science				✓
Attitude and Effort	Rarely	Inconsistently	Usually	Consistently
is prepared for class				✓
contributes positively in class				✓
completes set tasks				✓
acts on feedback to improve			✓	

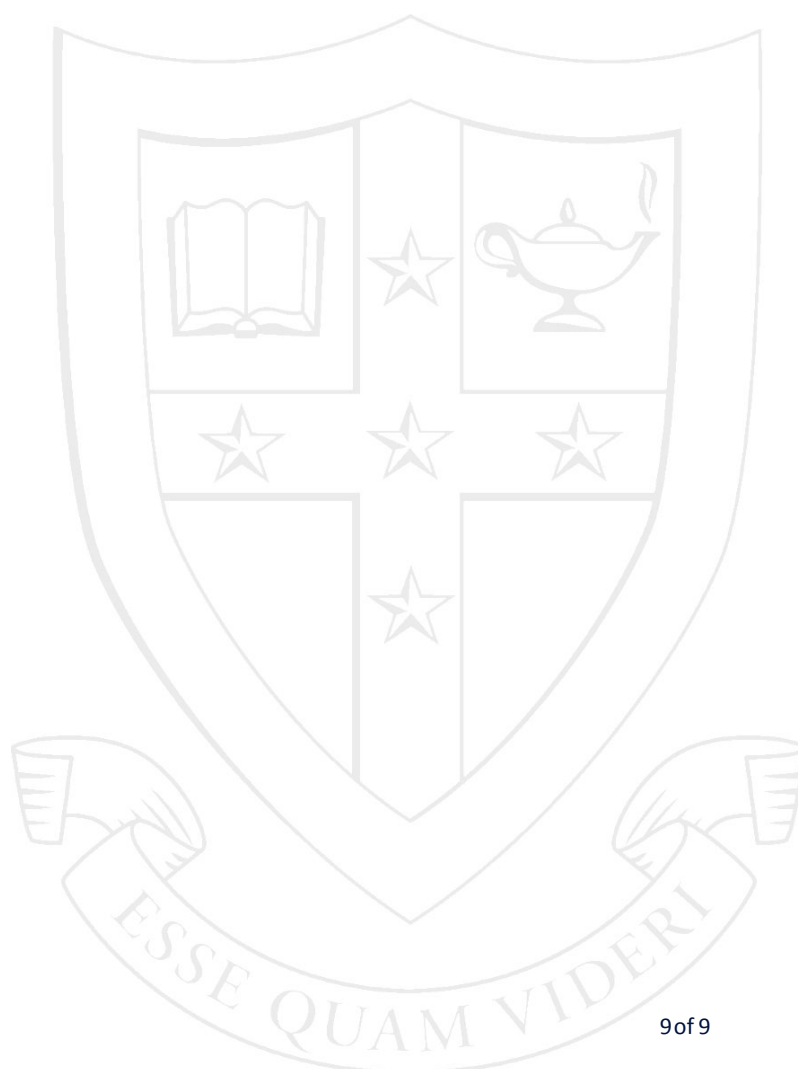
Performance grade: A Rank in assessment tasks: Task 4: =4/26

Conner has demonstrated thorough understanding from start to finish in Physics and should be commended on his efforts. With a sound result in the recent trial examination paper, Conner is well placed to finish the course with a strong result. He needs to place some emphasis on the relativity content from "Properties of Light" and be ready to address this content in extended response style questions. He has been a real asset to the class and someone who rose to the challenge in all the assessment tasks. I would encourage Conner to continue in this fashion and secure the strong result he absolutely deserves.

Teacher: Mr Timothy Lilley

Co-curricular summary

Sport	Football
Awards	Colours: Football





Education
Standards
Authority

Student eRecord

This record is produced from an online web-accessible system.
For information about NESA credentials – the Higher School Certificate (HSC)
and the Record of School Achievement (RoSA), go to educationstandards.nsw.edu.au

Conner Beris
of
Cranbrook School

STAGE 6 HSC COURSES

Enrolled in the following courses

Year Course

Board Developed Courses

2021 English Advanced (2 unit)
English Extension 1 (1 unit)
History Extension (1 unit)
Modern History (2 unit)
Physics (2 unit)

STAGE 6 HSC COURSES

Year	Course	Examination Mark	Assessment Mark/Grade	HSC Mark	Performance Band
Board Developed Courses					
2020	Chemistry (2 unit)	89/100	89/100	89	5
	Mathematics Advanced (2 unit)	96/100	93/100	95	6
	Mathematics Extension 1 (1 unit)	44/50	42/50	43	E3

Student Number: 33692188

Date produced: 23 September 2021

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**CRANBROOK
SCHOOL**

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ABN 79 000 007 723
CRICOS 02298E

8 September 2021

Senior School
5 Victoria Road
Bellevue Hill NSW 2023
02 9327 9000

Junior School
6 Kent Road
Rose Bay NSW 2029
02 9327 9100

St Mark's Pre-school
1 Greenoaks Avenue
Darling Point NSW 2027
02 9363 2260

St Michael's Pre-school
Cnr Gilliver Avenue
& Vaucluse Road
Vaucluse NSW 2030
02 9371 9214

To Whom It May Concern

Conner Beris

I am delighted to write in full support of the application made by Conner Beris. He commenced at Cranbrook School as a Kindergarten student and was offered a full Academic Scholarship for Senior School. He has emerged as a dedicated student, a capable sportsman, a rounded contributor to community life and an excellent citizen.

His HSC curriculum was formed by English Advanced, English Extension 1, History Extension, Modern History and Physics. He was an accelerated student in Yr 11 for HSC in Mathematics Advanced (95%), Chemistry (89%) and Mathematics Extension 1 (43/50). He received a number of Academic Excellence Prizes throughout his career and was consistently on the Headmaster's List of Outstanding Academic Attitude. He impressed his teachers with his diligence, commitment and focus. His teachers valued, and enjoyed, his positive, constructive approach to discussion and debate.

He involved himself in the performing arts: playing guitar in Guitar Ensembles, Junior School Choir and performing in the play *Lord of the Flies*. He represented the School in Tournament of Minds, Da Vinci Decathlon, ISDA and CAS debating, Algonquin Club and Maths Olympiad. In 2019 he was a member of the School Da Vinci team that was awarded 2nd in General Knowledge and was awarded overall 3rd in the State.

Beyond the classroom, he has been a force for good and an exemplary leader. Popular amongst his peers, and respected and liked by those younger than him, he has consistently been selected for positions of leadership, culminating in becoming a School Prefect for 2020/21. He exercises authority with good humour and kindness: his appointment as House Captain of Davidson House bears witness to the high opinion held of him by all sections of the school community. He has also been a powerful participant in service-related activity, having volunteered and involved himself regularly in Clean Up Australia Day, Red Cross Door Knock Appeal, Our Big Kitchen in Bondi and Randwick City Council Lifeguards.

He has also been a sportsman of note. Above all, he is an excellent team player: his positivity and skill have been evident in his favoured sport of Football, playing for the 1st XI team in 2020 and 2021 and awarded Colours. Identified as a talented footballer at an early age, he was selected and played at the highest tier in the NSW Football competition from 2013 to 2019. In 2013 and 2014 he was selected to play for U10's and U11's Sydney University (SAP programme). From 2015 he was selected to play for the Sydney Olympic Youth team. He transferred to St George FC U16's in 2019.

It can be seen, then, that he is determined to make the most of opportunity wherever he finds it and that he is an all-rounder with genuine warmth, sensitivity and energy. He would be a significant asset to any educational community and I can commend him to you wholeheartedly and without hesitation.

Yours sincerely

Nicholas Sampson
Headmaster